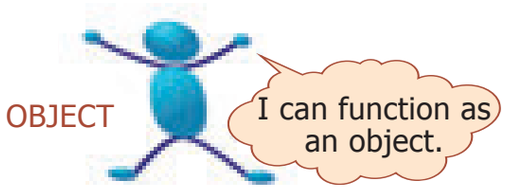
Infinitives and Gerunds

The infinitive is often called as 'to verb'



(e.g.) To swim is a good exercise.



(e.g.) I like to swim.

Infinitives may be used without **to** and we call such infinitives a plain infinitive or a bare infinitive.

(e.g.) She made me do my project.

We use plain/bare infinitives with these modals.

shall	will	do	did	would	make	need
may	might	could	must	let	dare	see

The infinitive may function as a subject, direct object, subject complement, adjective, or adverb in a sentence. Although an infinitive is easy to locate because of the *to+verb* form, deciding what function it has in a sentence depends on the meaning.

(e.g.) To wait seemed foolish when decisive action was required. *(subject)*

(e.g.) We intended to leave early. *(direct object)*

(e.g.) His ambition is to fly. *(subject complement)*

(e.g.) He lacked the strength to resist. *(adjective)*

(e.g.) We must study to learn. *(adverb)*

Gerunds

A gerund is an action word that ends in –ing and functions as a noun

D. Read the following pairs of sentences

Identify the subject.

- Travelling might satisfy your desire for new experiences.
- The study abroad program might satisfy your desire for new experiences.

Identify the direct object.

- They do not appreciate my singing.
- They do not appreciate my assistance.

Book 1.indb 70 21-01-2020 17:28:08